

Midterm Report

The design phase of this project was completed earlier in the semester and documented in the Design and Objectives Report. During that stage, the main goals of the website were defined, including the core sections of the site and the overall structure. The main pages include Home, People, Publications, Projects, and Highlights.

After completing the design phase, the focus of the project moved to implementation and development. I first set up the development environment and created the initial structure of the website. This included building the navigation system and creating the main pages of the site.

After the basic structure was ready, I started migrating content from the original website. This migration process has taken the largest portion of time so far. The original website content could not be moved directly, so many sections had to be manually reorganized and reformatted. Publications, project descriptions, and other information were rebuilt to match the new layout.

During weekly meetings with my supervisor, I showed demo versions of the website and received feedback on both functionality and design. Based on these discussions, several improvements were made. For example, the Publications page was updated to include images related to each paper. A Resources page was also added to organize useful links and research materials.

Another important part of the progress was improving the visual design of the website. Early versions of the site looked very simple, so I tested different layout and color options using CSS. After discussing these options with my supervisor, we selected a cleaner and more consistent design style. During spring break, I also updated the banner image and improved the layout so that the pages look more consistent.

At this point, the main structure of the website has been completed and most pages are functional in a demo version. A large portion of the migration work has already been finished, and the project is now moving toward content completion and final refinement.

Even though the main structure of the website is complete, there is still work to be done. The People page still needs more information. Some group members have not yet sent their photos or short biographies, so that page is not finished yet. Once I receive that information, I will add it to the website. The Publications page also needs additional updates. Some papers still need images and better formatting. The Highlights page has not been fully developed yet. This page will show recent achievements from the research group, such as new publications, student defenses, or other updates. The Resources page also needs more materials and links that my supervisor plans to send later. Finally, once all the content is added, we will review the entire website together and make final adjustments before the end of the semester.

One challenge during this project was deciding how to design the website so that it looks clean and professional. In the early versions, the website worked but the layout looked very plain. Some pages also looked inconsistent because the spacing, colors, and layout were not fully unified. To improve this, I tried several different CSS styles and layout ideas. During meetings with my supervisor, I showed different versions of the design and asked for feedback. My supervisor preferred a simple and minimal style but still wanted the website to look visually interesting. Because of this, I had to adjust the color scheme, page layout, and spacing multiple times until we found a style that worked well.

Another challenge was the migration process. Moving content from the old website to the new structure took more time than expected. The information on the old site could not be directly transferred, so it had to be manually reorganized and reformatted to fit the new page layout.

There was also a challenge related to collecting information for the People page. Some of the content depends on receiving photos and short biographies from group members. Since not everyone responded quickly, that page is still being updated as new information becomes available.

This project is an individual project, so all work has been completed by me. My work so far includes meeting with the supervisor weekly, planning the website structure, researching hosting solutions, setting up the development environment, building the main website framework, migrating content from the original website, creating pages such as Home, People, Publications, Projects, and Resources, improving layout and visual style, and revising the website based on feedback.

- Total time spent so far: approximately 73 hours
- Average time per week: approximately 10 hours
- Contribution: Longyu Tang — 100%

For the rest of the semester, I will continue improving and completing the website. First, I will finish adding information to the People page once I receive photos and biographies from the group members. Second, I will continue updating the Publications page and add images related to the papers. Third, I will begin developing the Highlights section and expand the Resources page. After the content is mostly complete, I will review the website with my supervisor and make final improvements.

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/LongyuT/research-website>

Work Log

Week 1:

Met with supervisor and reviewed the current Owlstown website, discussed project goals and identified the main pages of the new website – 1 hour

Reviewed the structure and content of the existing website, analyzed its strengths and weaknesses, and explored alternative approaches to structuring the site. – 1 hour

Total – about 2 hours

Week 2:

Researched possible hosting platforms and deployment options – 1.5 hours

Compared different methods for updating and maintaining the website – 1 hour

Discussed domain name and update workflow with supervisor – 0.5 hour

Total – about 3 hours

Week 3:

Set up development environment and project structure – 2 hours

Configured deployment workflow and connected the repository – 2 hours

Created initial website framework and navigation layout – 6 hours

Built the first demo homepage – 3 hours

Total – about 13 hours

Week 4:

Started migrating home and publication content from the original website – 7 hours

Rebuilt homepage content and reorganized text sections – 4 hours

Created initial structure for the People page – 2 hours

Adjusted navigation layout and page links – 2 hours

Total – about 15 hours

Week 5:

Continued migrating publications from the old website – 6 hours

Reformatted publication entries to fit the new layout – 4 hours

Created the Resources page and added initial structure – 3 hours

Minor layout adjustments for consistency – 2 hours

Total – about 15 hours

Week 6:

Tested different CSS layout and color schemes – 6 hours

Improved visual consistency across pages – 3 hours

Adjusted publication layout based on supervisor feedback – 2 hours

Refined spacing and alignment across the website – 3 hours

Total – about 14 hours

Week 7:

Updated banner image and homepage design – 2 hours

Improved layout consistency across all pages – 2 hours

Continued cleaning and adjusting migrated content – 5 hours

Fixed minor formatting and styling issues – 2 hours

Total – about 11 hours

Total: about 73 hours